Corteva Agriscience

Business Development Dossier

Industry	**Agriculture / Specialty Chemicals**
Revenue	**$17.7B**
Employees	**21,500**
Ideal Customer Profile Score	**75**

ICP SCORING MODEL


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ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit   (max 100)
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Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% | <90d: 30% | <180d: 20% | older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	$500M-$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below $500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 | Above $10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) | 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name Corteva, Inc.

Headquarters Indianapolis, Indiana

Founded 2019

Ownership

Public (NYSE: CTVA) - spun off from DowDuPont in 2019; heritage includes Dow, DuPont, and Pioneer (founded 1926)

Footprint

Operations across 6 continents; major presence in North America, South America, Europe, and Asia-Pacific; manufacturing and R&D facilities globally

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Corteva Agriscience is a global pure-play agriculture company spun off from DowDuPont in 2019, providing seed and crop protection products to farmers worldwide. The company operates through two segments - Seed (Pioneer, Brevant brands, $9.9B) and Crop Protection (herbicides, fungicides, insecticides, biologicals, $7.8B) - generating $17.7B in combined 2025 revenue with 21,500 employees across 6 continents. In October 2025, the board unanimously approved a plan to separate into two independent public companies by H2 2026, with CEO Chuck Magro leading the Seed spinoff and Chairman Greg Page leading New Corteva (Crop Protection).

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Corteva Agriscience's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Revenue: $17.4B in FY2025, up 2.9% YoY. Seed segment: $9.9B (56% of sales); Crop Protection: $7.8B (44%). Q1 2025 showed 3% price improvement in Seed and 5% volume increase in Crop Protection.

Profitability: Operating EBITDA reached $3.85B in FY2025, up 14% YoY. Operating EPS increased 30% to $3.34. GAAP income from continuing operations: $1.20B ($1.75 EPS).

2026 Guidance: Operating EBITDA target of $4.0 - $4.2B. 2027 value framework reaffirmed.

Analyst Sentiment: 14 analysts cover CTVA - 29% Strong Buy, 57% Buy, 14% Hold. Concerns about "deal purgatory" during separation period where stock may underperform. Oppenheimer flagged mixed investor reactions to breaking the "razor-and-blade" synergy model.

R&D Investment: ~8% of sales (~$1.4B annually), with ~500 new products planned for 2025 including ~300 new seed hybrids. Significant investment in gene editing (CRISPR-Cas), precision agriculture, and biologicals.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

[Separation PMO Leader] - SVP, Strategy / Separation Program Management [PRIORITY TARGET]

[To be confirmed]

> *Outreach rationale: Directly responsible for the organizational design challenge McChrystal can address - the separation PMO leader needs external expertise to build two standalone operating models within the H2 2026 deadline*

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Chuck Magro - Chief Executive Officer (future SpinCo CEO)

Former CEO of Nutrien; deep agricultural industry expertise

Greg Page - Chairman of the Board (future New Corteva Chair)

Former CEO of Cargill - extensive global agricultural leadership

Dave Anderson - EVP, Chief Financial Officer

Corporate finance and DuPont heritage

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Corteva Agriscience operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Matrixed global organization with two primary business segments (Seed and Crop Protection) supported by shared R&D, supply chain, and corporate functions. Country-level operations vary in integration degree between segments. Currently reorganizing into two standalone entities.

Culture Signals

Glassdoor rating: 4.1/5 (1,475 reviews); 82% would recommend. Work-life balance: 3.9/5; Culture and values: 3.9/5; Career opportunities: 3.6/5.

Positive themes: Flexible work arrangements, clear development plans, strong compensation. Heritage pride from Dow/DuPont/Pioneer legacy. Small autonomous teams with full domain ownership in some areas.

Challenge themes: "Organization is constantly changing" - repeated restructuring fatigue from DowDuPont separation and subsequent transformations. Workload can be overwhelming. Career opportunities rated lowest (3.6/5), suggesting advancement pathways unclear during transition periods. The upcoming separation is likely amplifying these concerns.

Cultural risk for separation: The company has a collaborative, cross-segment culture developed over decades. The separation structurally breaks the "razor-and-blade" collaboration model that many employees value. Risk of identity crisis for employees who identify with "Corteva" rather than one segment.

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Corteva Agriscience.

1. 2025-10-01 - Board unanimously approved plan to separate into two independent public companies (Seed and Crop Protection)

Massive organizational design challenge requiring external expertise in operating model design, leadership team buildout, and cross-functional coordination during separation

2. 2025-10-01 - CEO Chuck Magro named SpinCo (Seed) CEO; Chairman Greg Page to lead New Corteva (Crop Protection)

Leadership split creates need for dual team buildout - every functional leader must be allocated to one entity

3. 2025-08-06 - Strong Q2 2025 results - raised full-year guidance; operating EBITDA up 14%

Financial strength supports advisory spend; demonstrates business momentum that separation must not disrupt

4. 2025-10-01 - Analysts flag 'deal purgatory' risk and mixed investor reaction to separation

Board pressure to demonstrate execution capability; external advisory engagement signals organizational seriousness

5. 2025-10-01 - AI/data platform separation identified as key challenge - shared precision agriculture and gene editing platforms span both segments

Technology disentanglement requires organizational redesign of R&D collaboration, not just IT separation

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

> *Problem directly maps to McChrystal's organizational design and Team of Teams capability. Active trigger (Oct 2025 board approval), clear economic buyer (CFO/Separation PMO), budget exists ($17.7B revenue company with strong profitability), organizational urgency (H2 2026 hard deadline), and the gap incumbent advisors leave (human operating system during separation) is precisely McChrystal's sweet spot.*

Primary Problem

Building two fully independent operating models from a single integrated $17.7B global company in under 12 months - while maintaining business continuity, retaining talent, and preserving innovation velocity

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Team of Teams operating model implementation and organizational design - McChrystal's framework for shared consciousness and decentralized execution is directly applicable to maintaining coordination during corporate separation, and to building high-functioning independent teams from a single organization

Likely Objections to Engagement

McKinsey/Deloitte likely already engaged on separation strategy and IT - Corteva may view leadership advisory as lower priority

Agricultural industry may be skeptical of military-origin advisory frameworks without clear sector credentials

Separation timeline (H2 2026) may feel too compressed to engage new advisors now

Budget allocation may favor strategy and IT separation over 'soft' organizational design work

Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey - likely advising on separation strategy, portfolio optimization, and standalone business design

Deloitte - probable engagement on IT/systems separation, TSA design, and financial carve-out

Korn Ferry / Spencer Stuart - executive search and leadership assessment for new entity leadership teams

BCG - may be advising on innovation strategy and R&D portfolio allocation between entities

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. How are you thinking about maintaining cross-functional coordination across 6 continents during the separation - especially in regions where Seed and Crop Protection teams are deeply integrated?

Position McChrystal as having experience with high-stakes organizational transitions where maintaining operational tempo during restructuring is critical

2. What's your biggest concern about building two independent leadership teams from one - and how are you managing the talent retention risk during the transition?

Demonstrate understanding of the dual-entity leadership challenge without presuming to know their internal dynamics

3. With the agricultural calendar creating hard deadlines that most corporate separations don't face, how are you stress-testing the separation execution plan against planting season disruption risk?

Show sector awareness - agricultural companies can't afford the luxury of 'we'll figure it out later' that tech or financial services separations sometimes rely on

Recommended Meeting Framing

Frame as a peer conversation about organizational execution during high-stakes transitions - McChrystal Group has helped organizations maintain operational effectiveness during periods of maximum organizational disruption. Not a pitch for consulting services, but a discussion about the specific leadership and coordination challenges that separations create.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Corteva Agriscience's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Brand Value & Competitive Standing: Corteva is one of only four companies that dominate global agricultural inputs (alongside Bayer, Syngenta, and BASF). The Pioneer seed brand, established in 1926, is one of the most recognized names in agriculture. Brand differentiation centers on innovation - launching ~500 new products in 2025 including ~300 seed hybrids.

Brand Identity Evolution: The separation forces a fundamental brand identity decision - "Corteva" was created only in 2019 as a unified agricultural company. SpinCo will carry the Pioneer legacy (nearly 100 years of brand equity), while "New Corteva" retains the newer corporate brand. The separation tests whether "Corteva" has built enough brand equity in just 7 years to stand alone without the Pioneer association.

Brand Threats: Post-separation, each entity loses the brand halo of being a comprehensive agricultural solutions provider. Competitors (especially Bayer with its crop science + pharma backing) may position against the separated entities as too narrow. The "razor-and-blade" value proposition - farmers choosing Corteva because it offered integrated seed + chemistry solutions - disappears, requiring each entity to rebuild its market positioning independently.

Major Brand Investments: Corteva invests ~$1.4B annually in R&D, which underpins its innovation brand positioning. Post-separation, this investment must be allocated between entities, potentially diluting the innovation narrative for both. SpinCo's investment in gene editing (CRISPR-Cas) and New Corteva's push into biologicals represent distinct brand futures that must be clearly articulated to farmers, distributors, and investors.

McChrystal Connection: The brand separation challenge is fundamentally an organizational coordination problem - both entities need to simultaneously decouple their brand identity while maintaining customer relationships that span both. Farmers who buy Corteva seed AND Corteva crop protection will now be served by two separate companies, requiring seamless handoff design.

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Corteva Agriscience. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Corporate Separation Operating Model Design

Corteva must build two fully independent operating models from a single integrated company in under 12 months. This is not a simple carve-out - Seed and Crop Protection share R&D infrastructure, AI/data platforms, global supply chains, shared services, and a unified commercial organization. The separation requires disentangling deeply intertwined functions while maintaining business continuity across 6 continents. McKinsey and Deloitte can design org charts and map processes, but McChrystal's Team of Teams methodology is uniquely suited to the real challenge: how do you maintain shared consciousness and cross-functional coordination during a period when the organization is literally splitting in two? The urgency is acute - the board set an H2 2026 deadline, and analysts warn of "deal purgatory" if execution stumbles.

Competitor displacement logic: McKinsey would approach this as a strategy and process-mapping exercise; Deloitte would focus on IT separation and TSA design. McChrystal fills the gap neither can: building the human operating system that keeps 21,500 people coordinated during the most disruptive organizational event in the company's history.

Fit Dimension 2: Dual Leadership Team Buildout Under Time Pressure

The separation creates an unprecedented leadership challenge - Corteva must build two complete C-suites, two boards, and two management structures from one existing team. CEO Chuck Magro moves to lead SpinCo (Seed), and Chairman Greg Page leads New Corteva (Crop Protection). But below the top level, every VP, director, and functional leader must be allocated to one entity or the other, creating talent competition, retention risk, and institutional knowledge gaps. McChrystal's leadership development and team-building capabilities are directly relevant to standing up two high-functioning leadership teams simultaneously.

Competitor displacement logic: Korn Ferry and Spencer Stuart excel at individual executive placement. McChrystal addresses the systemic challenge: how do you build two leadership teams that can operate independently when they've spent years operating as one, and ensure both teams develop shared consciousness within their new entities?

Fit Dimension 3: AI/Data Platform Separation and Innovation Continuity

Corteva invests $1.4B+ annually in R&D (~8% of sales), with AI-driven precision agriculture, gene editing (CRISPR-Cas), and digital farming platforms that span both Seed and Crop Protection. Separating these shared technology assets - especially proprietary data models and AI platforms - without disrupting innovation velocity is one of the highest-risk aspects of the split. The company's "razor-and-blade" model (pairing seeds with complementary chemistries) has created deep cross-segment data dependencies. This requires not just technical separation but organizational redesign of how R&D teams collaborate post-split.

Competitor displacement logic: Accenture and BCG would focus on the technology architecture. McChrystal addresses the organizational dimension - redesigning how innovation teams work when the seamless cross-segment collaboration that drove Corteva's competitive advantage is being structurally eliminated.

Fit Dimension 4: Global Supply Chain Disentanglement

Corteva operates across 6 continents with manufacturing, distribution, and commercial operations that serve both segments through shared infrastructure. Separating global supply chains while maintaining service levels to farmers during critical planting seasons creates enormous operational risk. The agricultural calendar is unforgiving - a missed planting window means a lost year. This requires McChrystal's crisis-leadership and high-stakes decision-making capabilities.

Competitor displacement logic: Supply chain consultancies (Gartner, E&Y) can redesign logistics networks. McChrystal uniquely addresses the leadership challenge of making rapid, decentralized decisions across dozens of country operations during a high-stakes separation with zero margin for supply disruption.

9b. Cumulative Case - Why Corteva Is a Top Pipeline Opportunity

Corteva represents a rare convergence of organizational complexity and time pressure. The company is attempting to split a $17.7B, 21,500-person global operation into two standalone public companies in under 12 months - while maintaining business continuity, retaining talent, separating shared technology platforms, and disentangling global supply chains. Every dimension reinforces the others: leadership uncertainty creates talent retention risk, which threatens supply chain execution, which jeopardizes the separation timeline, which erodes analyst confidence.

Reinforcing signal chain: Board-approved separation (Oct 2025) -> dual leadership team buildout -> AI/data platform separation -> global supply chain disentanglement -> talent competition between entities -> innovation velocity risk -> analyst "deal purgatory" pressure -> board accountability for H2 2026 deadline

Revenue potential: $750K initial diagnostic and separation operating model design (4-6 months), expanding to $2M - $3M for full dual-entity leadership development and Team of Teams implementation across both New Corteva and SpinCo, with $500K - $1M ongoing advisory retainer through separation completion and first year of independent operations.

9c. Enterprise Issues & Organizational Challenges

1. Shared Services Bifurcation Without Operational Disruption Corteva's 21,500 employees are supported by centralized shared services - HR, IT, finance, legal, procurement - that must be duplicated for both entities. Building parallel shared services organizations while keeping the existing ones running is like rebuilding an airplane engine mid-flight. McChrystal's cross-functional alignment methodology can design the transition operating model that prevents service gaps during the switchover.

2. Talent Allocation and Retention Crisis Every mid-level and senior leader must choose (or be assigned to) one of two entities. High performers become retention risks as competitors (Bayer, Syngenta, BASF) recruit during the uncertainty. The "razor-and-blade" commercial model means many customer-facing employees have relationships spanning both segments - forcing them into one entity risks customer relationship disruption. McChrystal's leadership development programs can build engagement and purpose during the transition.

3. Innovation Culture Fragmentation Corteva's R&D strength comes from cross-pollination between Seed and Crop Protection - gene editing insights informing crop protection strategies and vice versa. Separation structurally eliminates this collaboration engine. Without intentional design, both entities risk losing the innovation culture that drove $1.4B+ in annual R&D investment. McChrystal can design post-separation collaboration frameworks that preserve beneficial cross-entity information sharing.

4. Regional Operating Model Inconsistency Corteva operates across 6 continents with varying degrees of integration between Seed and Crop Protection at the country level. Some countries have fully integrated commercial teams; others are more independent. This means the separation will look fundamentally different in each market, requiring locally adapted approaches within a globally consistent framework - exactly the kind of decentralized-yet-coordinated execution McChrystal's model enables.

5. Analyst and Investor Confidence Management Oppenheimer analyst Kristen Owen noted "mixed investor

reactions" to the separation, with concerns about destroying the "razor-and-blade" synergies. The company faces what analysts call "deal purgatory" - a period where stock performance stalls as investors wait for execution proof. Demonstrating organizational execution capability is essential to maintaining market confidence. McChrystal's frameworks provide visible, communicable evidence of execution discipline.

6. Agricultural Calendar Constraint Unlike most corporate separations, Corteva cannot afford execution delays because agricultural planting seasons create hard deadlines. A disruption during spring planting in North America or South America could result in permanent customer loss. This high-stakes, time-pressured environment is precisely where McChrystal's crisis leadership and empowered execution models excel.

9d. Expected Outcomes from McChrystal Group Engagement

1. Separation Operating Model Blueprint McChrystal would deliver a detailed dual-entity operating model that maps decision rights, communication architectures, and cross-functional coordination mechanisms for both New Corteva and SpinCo. Measurable result: reduce separation execution risk by establishing clear operating rhythms within 90 days of engagement, with weekly cross-functional alignment cadences.

2. Accelerated Leadership Team Cohesion McChrystal's leadership development programs would build high-performing teams for both new entities from the current Corteva leadership pool. Measurable result: achieve functional leadership team alignment for both entities within 120 days, reducing the typical 12-18 month "forming-storming-norming" cycle by 50%.

3. Talent Retention Through Purpose and Clarity By establishing clear organizational identity, mission, and operating rhythm for each entity, McChrystal would reduce the uncertainty that drives attrition during separations. Measurable result: keep voluntary attrition among top-quartile performers below 8% during the separation period (vs. industry average of 15-20% during major restructurings).

4. Innovation Velocity Preservation Design post-separation collaboration frameworks that maintain beneficial R&D cross-pollination through structured information-sharing mechanisms. Measurable result: maintain R&D pipeline throughput at 90%+ of pre-separation levels through the first 12 months of independent operations.

5. Regional Execution Consistency Implement McChrystal's decentralized execution model across all country operations, ensuring locally adapted separation execution within globally consistent guardrails. Measurable result: achieve on-time separation milestones in 90%+ of country operations, with no supply disruptions during critical planting seasons.

6. Stakeholder Confidence Building Provide visible execution framework that can be communicated to analysts, investors, and the board. Measurable result: positive analyst commentary on execution capability within two quarterly earnings cycles.

9e. Key Stakeholders & Business Unit Map

Corteva (Overall)

Leader: Chuck Magro
Function: CEO (moving to SpinCo CEO)
McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor; key relationship for SpinCo engagement

Corteva (Board)

Leader: Greg Page

Function: Chairman (moving to New Corteva Chair)

McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor for New Corteva; decision-maker on separation governance

Finance

Leader: Dave Anderson

Function: EVP, CFO

McChrystal Relevance: Controls budget for separation advisory spend; key stakeholder for operating model design

Seed Segment

Leader: [To be named]

Function: President, Seed

McChrystal Relevance: Priority target - will lead SpinCo's largest business unit; needs standalone operating model

Crop Protection

Leader: [To be named]

Function: President, Crop Protection

McChrystal Relevance: Priority target - will lead New Corteva's core business; needs independent team buildout

R&D / Technology

Leader: [To be named]

Function: Chief Technology Officer

McChrystal Relevance: Critical stakeholder for AI/data platform separation; innovation continuity

Global Operations

Leader: [To be named]

Function: SVP, Supply Chain

McChrystal Relevance: Key stakeholder for global supply chain disentanglement; agricultural calendar constraints

Human Resources

Leader: [To be named]

Function: CHRO

McChrystal Relevance: Critical for talent allocation, retention strategy, and dual-entity workforce planning

Strategy / Separation PMO

Leader: [To be named]

Function: SVP, Strategy

McChrystal Relevance: Top priority engagement target - owns separation execution timeline and operating model design

Legal / Compliance

Leader: [To be named]

Function: General Counsel

McChrystal Relevance: Tax-free separation structure, regulatory filings, IP allocation between entities

Priority engagement targets: (1) SVP of Strategy / Separation PMO leader - owns the execution timeline; (2) Seed Segment President - needs standalone operating model for SpinCo; (3) CFO Dave Anderson - controls advisory budget and is most likely economic buyer.

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Strategic Signal Convergence - Why Now Board-approved separation (Oct 2025) -> H2 2026 execution deadline -> dual leadership team buildout underway -> AI/data platform separation creates R&D risk -> global supply chain disentanglement during planting seasons -> talent competition between entities -> analyst "deal purgatory" pressure -> urgency to demonstrate execution capability NOW

The convergence is time-bound: Corteva is in the 12-month window where organizational design decisions will determine whether both entities launch as high-performing independent companies or stumble into years of post-separation dysfunction. Every month of delay increases execution risk.

The Structural Paradox - Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey McKinsey, BCG, and Deloitte are almost certainly already engaged on Corteva's separation - advising on strategy, IT separation, tax structure, and process design. But none of them solve the human operating system challenge: how do 21,500 people across 6 continents maintain coordination during a period of maximum organizational disruption? McKinsey designs the org chart; McChrystal builds the leadership and operating rhythms that make the org chart actually work. Deloitte separates the IT systems; McChrystal ensures the people using those systems can still make fast, coordinated decisions. This is the gap incumbent advisors consistently leave unfilled - and it's where separations fail.

Phased Engagement Hypothesis - Land and Expand

Phase 1 (Months 1-4): Separation Operating Model Diagnostic - $500K - $750K Scope: Assess current cross-functional dependencies between Seed and Crop Protection, map decision architectures, identify the 10 highest-risk separation workstreams, and design the dual-entity operating model blueprint. Start with 2-3 pilot country operations to test the model. Why this beachhead: The separation PMO needs an operating model framework immediately - they have a hard deadline and the board is watching. This is a bounded, high-value deliverable that demonstrates McChrystal's unique capability.

Phase 2 (Months 4-10): Dual-Entity Leadership Development - $1.5M - $2.5M Scope: Build high-performing leadership teams for both New Corteva and SpinCo through McChrystal's Team of Teams methodology. Implement shared consciousness operating rhythms for each entity. Roll out decentralized execution model across all country operations. Expansion logic: Phase 1 diagnostic reveals specific leadership gaps and team dysfunction that only McChrystal can address at scale.

Phase 3 (Months 10-18): Post-Separation Stabilization and Advisory - $500K - $1M/year Scope: Ongoing advisory to both entities during first year of independent operations. Quarterly leadership alignment sessions. Innovation collaboration framework monitoring.

Competitive Displacement Strategy Corteva's separation will involve multiple advisory firms. McChrystal should position as complementary - not competing with McKinsey on strategy or Deloitte on IT. The pitch: "Your strategy advisors design what the organization should look like; we build the leadership and operating system that makes it work." Entry through the separation PMO or CHRO, who own the people side of the separation. Procurement bypass: position as a leadership development engagement (different budget line than management consulting), or enter through a direct relationship with the Separation PMO leader.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit Map

Thread 1: Separation PMO / Strategy Target: SVP of Strategy or Separation PMO leader Angle: "We've helped organizations navigate high-stakes transitions where the operating model had to change faster than the org chart" Vector: Direct outreach; conference proximity at agricultural industry events (Commodity Classic, Farm Progress Show)

Thread 2: CHRO / Talent Target: Chief Human Resources Officer Angle: "Leadership team cohesion and talent retention during separation - our programs reduce transition attrition by 50%" Vector: Direct outreach; CHRO network connections; HR leadership conferences

Thread 3: Board / Chairman Greg Page Target: Greg Page (Chairman, future New Corteva Chair) Angle: Page's background as former Cargill CEO means he understands the stakes of organizational transformation in agriculture at global scale Vector: McChrystal personal network; board-level introductions through shared connections in agricultural leadership circles; potential military/veteran angle if applicable